SpeechGeek Presents



Female/Female Duos, Vol. 3

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SpeechGeek Presents F/F Duos, Vol. 3

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We knew--at least anecdotally--that female/female duo interp scripts were some of the most challenging lit to find.

With that hunch, we published our first special issue of these scripts nearly two years ago. In the time since then, the issues have been our best individually-selling scripts in the history of our store.

More importantly, coaches have written to thank us for listening to what they need and, in turn, working with our authors to come up with some great new lit.

We hope you enjoy this third installment of female/female duos! Have a thought for another type of **SpeechGeek Presents** series? Let us know. We love hearing from you.

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Go On, Girl!

by Rebecca Spero

CAROLYN. I'm in the clear. You?
JILL. Nothing — and thank God for that!
CAROLYN. You okay?
JILL. Honey, I'm relieved! I can't have kids right now – we just took the plastic off the furniture.
CAROLYN. Well, Phillip is not going to be pleased. I'm just not ready for motherhood. Life is hard.
JILL. Yeah, living in a posh suburban neighborhood can be a real bummer.
CAROLYN. I just wish life were simple..like…like in high school!
JILL. LIKE IN HIGH SCHOOL!
CAROLYN. Do you still remember it?
JILL. Girl, please.
BOTH. 5,6,7,8 We'll always be bosom buddies/Friends sisters and pals/we'll always be bosom buddies/If life should reject you/There's me to protect you. APPLAUSE.
CAROLYN. Remember when we were going to be on Broadway?
JILL. Who says we still can't?
CAROLYN. Phillip.
JILL. You know what I say? SCREW 'EM.
CAROLYN. Jill!
JILL. That's right. Screw Phillip and screw Roger. SCREW 'EM.
CAROLYN. Jill!
JILL. Do you feel trapped?
CAROLYN. More than you'll ever know.
JILL. Are you lonely?
CAROLYN. More than you'll ever know.
JILL. Then let's get the hell out of here!
CAROLYN. OKAY! Wait, how?
JILL. Carolyn, we're divorcing our husbands!
CAROLYN. YAY! Oh, crap.

INTRO

(Said in tandem.)
JILL. (*overly sure of herself*) Roger, now you listen to me you son-of-a-gun.
CAROLYN. Oh, I don't even know how to do something like this.
JILL. Carolyn and I are going to Vegas.
CAROLYN. Well…
JILL. What do you think of that?

CAROLYN. I think we're going to take a breather…
JILL. Goodbye Roger – I'll mention you fondly in my first tell-all book.
CAROLYN. That's right I'm leaving you.
JILL. Have fun with your ugly tramp.
CAROLYN. I think.
(Both take a deep breath.)

SCENE CHANGE

CAROLYN. Oh my God! Where are we? I feel like complete trash.
JILL. Honey, we're at a Marriott in downtown Vegas.
CAROLYN. If the low thread count gives me a rash, I'm out of here.
JILL. We'll be fine – plus we can have all the room service we want since I went ahead and cleared out mine and Roger's savings account.
CAROLYN. (*taken back*) Whoa…
JILL. What!?
CAROLYN. You're serious…
JILL. And you're not?
CAROLYN. Well…yeah…I guess I just…
JILL. You just weren't smart enough to clear out the savings account? You know it's your money, too, sweetheart?
CAROLYN. Right.
JILL. Okay, well – if we're going to do this – we're going to do it right.
CAROLYN. Right.
JILL. Carolyn, we've left that old life and we're on to bigger and better things now. Let's get started on this act.
CAROLYN. Right-o! (*grabs notebook and pencil*)
JILL. I thought we would start with a little singing and dancing….
CAROLYN. Yes and yes!
JILL. And we'll put in some stand up.
CAROLYN. …and this is the part when Carolyn leaves the stage…
JILL. No. No. No! We do all of this together. (*Carolyn looks freaked out.*) The whole show. (*Carolyn stands paralyzed with fear.*) All of it. (*Carolyn stands frozen with fear.*) What? Snap out of it!
CAROLYN. But, I'm not funny…
JILL. It doesn't matter – I'll do all of the work…
CAROLYN. Then why am I even doing this show? Okay…so I'm going to tell a joke and you're going to give some one liner that you can do time and again that will keep the show running.
CAROLYN. Oh – well I can do that, silly!
JILL. Right. Ok – so here we go. I recently left my husband…
CAROLYN. PREACH!
JILL. Ok, you can't say "preach."
CAROLYN. Ok…I'll try again.
JILL. Ok – so recently I left my husband, Roger.
CAROLYN. BOOM!

JILL. Carolyn…
CAROLYN. Was it too much?
JILL. Too much.
CAROLYN. Okay I got it.
JILL. (*with hesitation*) Alrighty – I am recently a divorcee – that's right I left my husband, Roger…
CAROLYN. Go on, girl!
JILL. Carolyn!
CAROLYN. WHAT?
JILL. It works!

SCENE CHANGE

(*Both women have their backs turned to audience.)*
JILL. And now…please welcome to the stage the good girls gone bad…
CAROLYN. And here for you tonight at …aw crap, where are we?
JILL. Carolyn! Really!? Don't screw this up for me.
CAROLYN. I'm sorry! I don't know where we are!
JILL. RIGHT HERE (*points to the correct place on notecard*)!
CAROLYN. …at Trixy's Bar and Grill on 4th Street…
JILL. Please give a warm desert welcome for the premier performance of, *Go on, Girl*!
(Singing to the tune of "Bosom Buddies" from MAME…)
We'll always be housewife honeys
Thin, pretty, and fair
We'll always be housewife honeys
We'll take all your money and
Leave you on Monday

(Jill is working the audience like a stand up comedian, Carolyn is her sidekick.)

JILL. So before I left Roger, I would always find other women's whore-panties all over the place.
CAROLYN. Go on, girl!
JILL. But when I found a red see through crotchless number clogging the garbage disposable…he told me it was a gift! Happy Anniversary.
(Carolyn looks slightly upset.)
JILL. Oh, you guys are great—here's another one for you! Roger and I had worked out a system …a little something I call "Don't ask because I don't freaking wanna know."
CAROLYN. Go on, girl!
JILL. But it worked out. Plus, I think I'd rather have a distant husband, than a curfew….Right, Carolyn?
CAROLYN. (*pause*) (*to audience*) Just one second…I'm going to talk to her real quick..(*to Jill*) We cut that from the show.

JILL. No, we didn't.

CAROLYN. Yes, we did…remember we said we weren't going to make fun of each other?

JILL. They are laughing…

CAROLYN. Okay, but just so you know…it wasn't REALLY a curfew. It was only midnight so it wasn't even really that bad…

JILL. Carolyn!

CAROLYN. I'm sorry! GO ON, GIRL!

JILL. But it's not her fault, I even have to tell her before the show to go tinkle, because that's been happening, huh sweetie? Her brain is about as small as her bladder.

(Carolyn getting increasingly upset)

JILL. Watching TV the other night I saw that jellyfish are spineless and I thought "Why call them jellyfish? I'd call them Carolyn!" Carolyn on the other hand, I don't wanna say baby girl was on a leash, but like, heel.

CAROLYN. Jill!

JILL. What? Go on, girl….

CAROLYN. Forget it.

(*Carolyn walks off the stage*.)

JILL. Okay…well…thanks for coming out tonight! You've been a great audience!

SCENE CHANGE

JILL. Oh, man, that was a great show, honey. Especially the part before you walked off the stage.

CAROLYN. Yeah, well, I'm surprised you noticed…considering this show has become all about you.

JILL. No, it's not. It's called *Go on, Girl* because you say "Go on, Girl."

CAROLYN. After everything you say.

JILL. I'm sorry – it's just that you're the happy one and I'm the snarky, yet clever, one.

CAROLYN. Well, guess what, take a look around Jill because I'm not happy – and maybe it's my turn to be the snarky one.

JILL. Carolyn…

CAROLYN. I'm quitting the show.

JILL. (*surprised*) This is out of nowhere…

CAROLYN. Well, maybe I'm hormonal!

JILL. (*pause*) I'm sorry, what?

CAROLYN. (*pause*) I'm pregnant.

JILL. Since when?

CAROLYN. Since before we left for Vegas.

JILL. (*point blank*) Listen, we made a pact. We were going to do this together. We were going to leave those poor excuses for husbands back in California – we were moving to Vegas to be stars – and you

had to ruin EVERYTHING!

CAROLYN. Jill, this isn't about me anymore.

JILL. What am I supposed to do, huh?

CAROLYN. Just go back….

JILL. Go back to what!? We're getting a divorce, Carolyn. It was over before it even started. I can't do that anymore. I can't live that life the way that you can. I can't smile and pose and always say the right thing. HE DIDN'T WANT ME. And what's different now is that I don't care enough to try anymore.

CAROLYN. Jill…

JILL. Carolyn, you want to go—so go.

CAROLYN. Fine.

SCENE CHANGE

(*A few months later…Jill is drunk on stage performing for a dark theatre. She is alone*.)

JILL. So, how's everyone doing tonight? Alright! Well, I'm Jill – the official Housewife Honey. Alright, the only problem is…in order to be a Housewife you actually need to be married. I'm not married. (*stutter, silence, awkward*) What are you doing here?

CAROLYN. Show's been cancelled. Jill…I got a call.

JILL. What? No. the show goes on without you, Carolyn!

CAROLYN. You know, Jill, you can come home with me right now.

JILL. No! I have friends here, I—I have fans here…they LOVE me!

CAROLYN. Jill, I'm the only person here.

JILL. (*pause, with sadness*)….I know.

CAROLYN. Jill, come home with me. I could really use your help.…SHE could really use your help (referencing her stomach).

JILL. Why did you come here?

CAROLYN. Because we said we'd always be bosom buddies. I'm here to protect you.

JILL. Applause…

CAROLYN. Let's go home, Jill.

JILL. Okay. Take me home.

Tips

by Julia Neva

Author's Note: *The best approach is to pair a performer with a knack for multiple characters with someone who can be likeable, identifiable, and carry the audience through the chaos. Blocking would be best served by letting Susan cross in front of the other character to signal that she is either in the kitchen area, or at a new table.*

SUSAN. 17 years old, eager, enthusiastic, perfectionist who is working her first job.
MANAGER. 35 years old, bored, monotone, feels like she's done this routine a thousand times.
MOTHER. 40 year old woman with three unruly kids under the age of five, always shouting at everyone.
CORPORATE. 30 year old woman on a power trip, rude and nasty.
OLD WOMAN. 90 year old woman, moves slower than dial-up internet.
SOLO DINER. 25 years old, even tempered and just there to have a quick bite to eat.

SUSAN. (*looking at watch)* Okay. It's 10:18 a.m. I know the manager said I could swing by around 10:30, but as mom always said, "If you're not ten minutes early, you're five minutes late," so I figured getting here at 9:30 and waiting for (*looks at watch*) forty-*nine* minutes now would CLEARLY illustrate that I am not only punctual but reliable. Thank goodness for this job. My parents' twentieth anniversary is coming up, and this cash will really help me out with-
MANAGER. (*interrupts*) Susan?
SUSAN. Yes! Yes, I am! Susan Coleman. (*joking*) No relation!
MANAGER. (*confused*) Huh?
SUSAN. Uh. Y'know…Susan G. Komen. They do research and charity walks.
MANAGER. No, I know who Susan G. Komen is. What I don't know is why you'd make a joke like that to someone you've never really met before. What on earth were you thinking?
SUSAN. (*mortified*) Oh. My. Gobstoppers. I am SO sorry. I can't believe I said that. I was just trying to break the ice. (*on the verge of tears*) This is my first job and I just wanted…
MANAGER. (*interrupts*) Eh, I'm just pulling your leg.
SUSAN. You're what?
MANAGER. You gotta loosen up, kid. But seriously, don't make that joke to your tables. Cancer references don't really work up folks' appetite, if you know what I mean.
SUSAN. Yes, ma'am. Once again. SO. VERY. SORRY.
MANAGER. Now, unfortunately…Stacey won't be here for you to shadow today. It seems her cat ate an entire roll of aluminum foil and had to be taken to the vet because it was shooting glitter out its south side, if you catch my drift.
SUSAN. Ew.
MANAGER. I know. Anyway. You'll be flying solo today. (*Susan looks panicked, but the manager keeps rushing through the following at a lightning fast pace.*) I know that Ricky, the assistant manager, has walked you through how to take orders, where the drink station, dishes, kitchen, and prep line are. You have your book, apron, pens, and change. Break large bills at the bar. Remember, greet the customers first, tell them our specials, push the appetizers, get their drink order, place order for appetizers, return with drinks and rolls, take their main order, place the order on the computer, deliver any appetizers, salads, or soups, refill drinks, remove dirty plates, return with entrees, refill drinks, run anyone else's food that is waiting on the line, make sure everything tastes okay with your table, push desserts, print check, run credit cards, thank them, then bus the table so you can turn it over for the next customers, who by the way, are ALWAYS RIGHT and must be kept happy AT ANY COST. (*take a beat*) Sound good?
SUSAN. Who's Ricky?
MANAGER. (*unfazed*) You'll do great. Don't forget to smile.
SUSAN. (*meekly smiles, looks terrified*)

INTRODUCTION

SUSAN. Hello! Welcome to DelMadre's, my name is…
CORPORATE. (*on cell phone*) I don't CARE that Jeffries just had a lung transplant. I want his report on the fiscal year earnings pronto or he's going to need a leg transplant because I will rip them off WITH MY BARE HANDS.
SUSAN. Oh. I can come back…
CORPORATE. (*on cell phone*) Hold on a sec. (*to SUSAN, condescendingly*) Hey, princess. Didn't your basement-dwelling Neanderthal parents teach you that it is rude to interrupt someone who is the on the phone?
SUSAN. (*in shock*) Uh…
CORPORATE. Use your words. I know you can speak.
SUSAN. Can I get you something to drink?
CORPORATE. You *may bring me* a club soda with three lime wedges and no ice. (*on phone*) Sorry, Phil, some people have ZERO manners.
SUSAN. Right away. (*to herself*) Well, that was fun. Oops. The hostess just double sat me. I better grab their drink order real quick – then I'll make all the drinks at once. (*to mother*) Hello! Welcome to DelMadre's, my name is…
MOTHER. (*yelling at imaginary kids*) *GEORGETTE*! You had better sit your bee-hind down in this booth or I'm going to staple your shorts to the

seat. No, Julian, you can't go back out to the car for your Spongebob toy you're just going to have to sit still. Michaela, I doubt they have tzatziki on the kids' menu so you're just going to have chicken fingers.

SUSAN. (*smiling*) Looks like you've got your hands full.

MOTHER. Ha. Ha. You think?

SUSAN. Well, my name is…

MOTHER. Look, I'll have a Sprite with some limes on the side. The girls will have lemonade and Julian – chocolate milk.

SUSAN. (*writing it down*) Okay. Would you like any appetizers?

MOTHER. (*cringes from the kids yelling in unison, snaps at kids*) NO. NO. NO!! WE ARE NOT GETTING MOZZARELLA STICKS. BE QUIET AND STOP YELLING!! (*to Susan*) Thanks a lot, kiddo. I think the drinks will be just fine for right now.

SUSAN. Yes ma'am. One adult Sprite, two kids' lemonades, and one kid's chocolate milk.

MOTHER. The limes?

SUSAN. Oh, yes. With limes on the side. I'll be right back with your drinks! (*going to drink station to make drinks)* Phew. Okay. Just calm down, Susan. You can do this. Remember, you're feeding the hungry. This is a noble job. Just smile and… (*looks down*) Oh, monkey feathers. Club soda and Sprite look exactly the same. (*looks up*) Double monkey feathers. The hostess just sat another two tables in my section. SERIOUSLY?! (*crossing to Corporate*) Well, I'll take a guess. What's the worst that could happen. (*hands drink to Corporate*) Here's your drink, ma'am.

CORPORATE. (*takes a drink*) Uuughhh! Are you TRYING to kill me?

SUSAN. (*pretends to be surprised*) Oh, what seems to be the matter?

CORPORATE. This clearly isn't club soda.

SUSAN. Ha, ha. It looks pretty clear to me.

CORPORATE. Do you think incompetence is funny?

SUSAN. No, but patience is a virtue.

CORPORATE. Are you calling me impatient?

SUSAN. No, I'm sorry. I was just trying to lighten the mood.

CORPORATE. Well, you're lightening my bill. I want the drink I ordered and I want it for free.

SUSAN. I don't know if I can…

CORPORATE. I also want a grilled chicken breast with no marinade. Seriously, because if I taste a drop of seasoning on it I will flip out. Then, I need steamed veggies – but no cauliflower and a baked potato with chives only. Can you handle that?

SUSAN. (*forcing a* smile) Not a problem. (*takes drinks to Mother's table*) Here you go. I'll be back to take your order in a few…is that purple sawdust on your table?

MOTHER. Georgette shredded your crayons. We'll need more when you get back. JULIAN! That napkin is for wiping our mouths…not our

bottoms!

SUSAN. Ew. (*to new table, less chipper and increasingly rushed*) Welcome to Del Madre's, I'm…

OLD WOMAN. (*in a soft voice, just barely louder than a whisper*) Do you have a senior citizen special?

SUSAN. Excuse me?

OLD WOMAN. (*still quiet*) Do you have a senior citizen special?

SUSAN. Ma'am, I'm going to need you to speak louder.

OLD WOMAN. (*suddenly shouting*) CHOWDER? No. It's too warm out for chowder.

SUSAN. Okay. What can I get you to drink?

OLD WOMAN. No, sweetie. My blouse is mauve. Go fetch me a cup of coffee and a…(*long pause as she stares that the menu*)

SUSAN. I can give you more time if you want.

OLD WOMAN. No, no. Just give me a moment. (*another ridiculously long pause that makes SUSAN look stressfully at her fourth table*) Water.

SUSAN. Anything else?

OLD WOMAN. Yes. (*pause*) But not now. I'm waiting for someone.

SUSAN. (*sarcastic*) Tell me about it. I'll be right back with those drinks. (*completely frazzled*) Hey. Del Madre's. Drink?

SOLO. Oh, hello. (*Susan is searching for a pen.)* Busy day?

SUSAN. Yeah. My first day, too. ARGH! Where is that pen?

SOLO. Not to sound like a kiddie magician, but check behind your ear.

SUSAN. Huh? (*checks*) Ah. You're good.

SOLO. I try.

SUSAN. Okay. So what can I get you to drink?

SOLO. Well, if it makes your life any easier, I know what I'm going to order. Just a Coke, cheeseburger cooked medium, and fries, please.

SUSAN. Will anyone else be joining you?

SOLO. Nope, it's just me today.

SUSAN. Alrighty. I'll have that right out. (*returns to kitchen)* Okay. (*pulls out book, looks incredibly lost, begins a series of juggling plates and drinks through the following series of complaints*) Now, where was I?

CORPORATE. (*talking in a loud, passive aggressive manner)* How long does it take to get a piece of chicken around here? Are you plucking the bird yourself?

SUSAN. I'm sorry, it will be just a few more minutes.

MOTHER. Miss? MISS?? I'm still waiting to place my order. My kids are starving.

SUSAN. Yes ma'am, just let me grab a new pen and I'll be right with…

OLD WOMAN. This coffee tastes rusty. It's cold in here. Where's my chowder?

SUSAN. You didn't order the chowder, ma'am.

CORPORATE. I've got 15 minutes before I have to be back in the office!! (*to phone)* Not you.

SUSAN. I'm going as fast as…

MOTHER. This is absolutely ridiculous, GEORGETTE!!! STOP LICKING THE

BUSBOY!

SUSAN. That's…not sanitary.

CORPORATE. I've gotten better service at a gas station. My meal had better be free.

SUSAN. I'm sorry. I can bring you some bread.

MOTHER. Bread? If I wanted to feed my kids bread, I'd just toss a loaf of Wonder Bread in their room and let them scrap over it. I wanna talk to a manager.

SUSAN. I don't think you have to do that.

OLD WOMAN. Beets are gross!

SUSAN. You don't make any sense!!! ARGH! What is it with you people? You rush me around like a maniac, complain over the tiniest things, are completely rude when I try to fix everything and you can't even call me by my own name. Is it any wonder everything in the world is so horrible that we would treat a total stranger like an indentured servant? And for what? Two bucks an hour plus tip? All I wanted was to get my parents a gift for their…

SOLO. Susan?

SUSAN. And another thing…wait…what?

SOLO. That's your name, right?

SUSAN. How did you know?

SOLO. You're wearing a nametag.

SUSAN. Oh.

SOLO. I'm a keen observer, I know.

SUSAN. Look, I'm sorry. I haven't been a very good server for you. I've just been completely swamped since I've started. Can I get you a brownie or something?

SOLO. Nah. It's all good. I was a waiter before. I left the cash for my check on the table. Keep the change.

Somewhere in Between

by Meredith Allen

STACY. Age 28, high powered attorney who has no time for people.

GOD. A female version of the higher power who is brassy and sassy.

WOMAN. Age 80, very abrasive.

MOTHER. Various ages in the piece, caring and loving.

One performer should play the role of Stacy. The other performer should play the roles of God, Old Woman, and Mother.

GOD. It all started out like a typical day for Stacy Pritchett. She was on her way to work (*from behind her, walking*) gave a quick hello to a passerby…

STACY. (*said fastly*) Hello.

GOD. Stopped by to get the morning paper…

STACY. *Times* please. Thanks.

GOD. Thank you. Stacy Pritchett stood at the corner of 57th and 7th and waited for the crosswalk light to tell her when to walk. Just then, Stacy's cell phone rang.

STACY. Listen, Mother, I can't…I can't talk right now.

GOD. Not known for her patience and worried she would be late to work...

STACY. No, Mother. I will call you after work. Goodbye.

GOD. Stacy decided to walk quickly across the street, and her typical day became untypical. She took two steps and…Stacy was hit by an oncoming bus.

Setting: Purgatory, of sorts…

(Stacy is out of breath, God is doing paperwork on Stacy.)

STACY. (*freaking out*) OH. MY. GOD!

GOD. (*joking*) That's my name, don't wear it out…(*giggles into a snort, she doesn't laugh*) Sorry. You're new here.

STACY. You're God?

GOD. All day, every day my friend…

STACY. God's a woman!?

GOD. You thought God was a man?

STACY. Listen, if you're a witch – I'm cool with alternative lifestyles…but tell me where I am…

GOD. No, I'm God. (*in a semi rap*) You know G-O-D, yeah that spells me!

STACY. Just tell me where am I?

GOD. Well, Stacy, that's for you to decide…

INTRO

GOD. Why don't you sit down? SIT!

STACY. I'm sorry. You seem like a nice person and I'm trying really hard to not FREAK OUT on you…but you are going to need to tell me where I am.

GOD. You are not in hell. You are not in heaven. You are somewhere in-between.

STACY. (*losing her cool*) Pardon me, but *nothing you have said in the last…oh…30 seconds hasn't made any sense at all!*

GOD. (*quite frank*) You were hit by a bus.

STACY. (*pauses*) Ok. So, essentially you are telling me I'm dead.

GOD. Hm – tough call.

STACY. What do you mean it's a tough call!?

GOD. Listen, you're getting on my nerves. Here let's just watch a movie called "YOUR LIFE" and we'll figure this whole thing out together.

STACY. I'm going to vomit or pass out or both!

GOD. Chill out! This is just standard procedure – it's really turned rather clinical – you sit in a chair – I pull down a screen projector (*pulls screen projector down from sky*) – and we watch portions of your life.

STACY. (*cynical*) Yes, of course, standard procedure – nothing out of the ordinary – just the fact that I'm, you know, dead. And I'm watching home videos in heaven with a girl God. This is exactly how I planned my Tuesday.

GOD. (*getting projector set up)* I can see you're upset. But, it won't do you any good. Everyone whether they believe in me or not will have to go through this and the reason why we watch your life over again is to decide.

STACY. Decide what?

GOD. If you stay. If you stay or if you go.

STACY. (*sarcastic*) Oh, great. I'm a goner.

GOD. Let's start with day one. (*clicks slide*) Cute kid. And we're not going to get anywhere just by looking at your childhood are we? That's not going to tell us much, will it? Let's just start with something ran dom…

(During these next few slides, God will be playing various people in Stacy's life. Stacy will be various ages depending on the scene.

STACY. (*age 9, clearly has speech issues due to braces*) Hello, my name is Stacy Pritchett, would you like to buy some cookies from the local Girl Scouts? It would get me a badge and send me to summer camp!

WOMAN. Get off my front porch, brace face!

STACY. (*adult*) So does everyone have that bad of a childhood?

GOD. Mmmhmm. Ah, my favorite part of the journey– puberty…

STACY. Oh, God…

GOD. Yes?

STACY. Let's just get this over with, shall we?

GOD. (*as she's clicking*) Alright – so here we are….first pimple.

STACY. Yeah, thanks for those by the way…

GOD. Okay, here's something pretty monumental…day number 5,675, age fifteen…

(God is now playing the role of Stacy's mother. Stacy is 15 and her mother is in her 40s.)

MOTHER. Now listen, you are going to go with Benny Baldwin to the Valentines Dance and you are going to like it!

STACY. But, mother, he's a complete dork!

MOTHER. You liked him no less than two weeks ago!

STACY. That was before Gina and Sarah told me that he has a sweating problem!

MOTHER. Everyone sweats, honey!

STACY. Not like Benny…

MOTHER. Listen, how would you feel if someone stood you up the way you want to stand Benny up? It's called being an adult and growing up. Sometimes we have to do things that are not fun because it's the right thing to do.

STACY. I don't want to be an adult. This sucks!

GOD. Well, that looked like a lot of fun…

STACY. Oh, boy, was it!

GOD. Did you end up going to the dance with Benny?

STACY. Yeah…

GOD. You know you can't lie to me, right?

STACY. (*sheepishly*) He sat on the bleachers the entire night and watched me slow dance with Tim Walker.

GOD. Hm…

STACY. Is this whole slide projector deal just supposed to make me feel bad – because if so you are doing a BANG UP job!

GOD. That slide wasn't about Benny – it was about your mother. Day 7,409…

(God is now playing the role of Stacy's mother. Stacy is 21 and her mother is in her 50s now.)

STACY. (*age 20*) Hey mom…

MOTHER. (*age 50*) Stacy, sit down.

STACY. What is it, mom?

MOTHER. You're dad called…and he's not coming home.
STACY. Oh, that's cool…
MOTHER. Ever.
STACY. (*pause*) What do you mean?
MOTHER. He's not coming home ever.
STACY. Well, why?
MOTHER. He's found someone else…
STACY. I can't believe this!
MOTHER. Neither can I…
STACY. This is all your fault!
MOTHER. What are you talking about?
STACY. YOU MADE HIM FIND SOMEONE ELSE!
MOTHER. Stacy…
STACY. If you had just lost some weight…
MOTHER. Really?
STACY. If you would have been less annoying…
MOTHER. Stacy, you have no idea what you are talking about…
STACY. I will never forgive you for this…I hate you!

GOD. So, I'm guessing that struck a nerve…
STACY. And thank you for yet another clip showcasing the exact way Stacy Pritchett is awful.
GOD. Yes, but you thought you were right.
STACY. I was JOKING!
GOD. I'm afraid not...
STACY. You're kidding, right? So, I did all of that work for nothing? Because you didn't even show when I got named partner or that time I won… that one case...
GOD. In the end, none of that really matters. It was a means to an end. And your means were...mean.
STACY. No! NO! That's completely wrong! I WAS A GOOD PERSON! Bring me back to life. Give me another chance. I know what to do now!
GOD. Watch this – day number 10,476…

(God is now playing the role of Stacy's mother. Stacy is 28 and her mother is now 60.)

STACY. (*age 28*) Mother, I can't stay for long…I have at least four more appointments all before dinner…what is it that you needed?
MOTHER. (*age 60*) Well, if I'm keeping you, I'll just have to be brief. I just wanted to tell you that I have breast cancer and that I think you should get tested as well.
STACY. Excuse me?
MOTHER. I found a lump in my breast and they have said that I needed to tell all the women in my family as it may be hereditary and…

STACY. (*rushed, annoyed*) I don't have time for this…this is ridiculous…
MOTHER. It's stage four, Stacy…
STACY. (*annoyed*) So? What does that mean?
MOTHER. It means I'm dying and I'm probably not going to get better.
STACY. (*angry*) Oh PERFECT! That's just great!
MOTHER. I can understand why you're angry – the doctor said this might happen.
STACY. First you have your own death sentence, and now you're trying to work on mine…Thanks, mom!
MOTHER. Stacy, please just calm down!
STACY. Let me know when the funeral is, okay? I've gotta go!

GOD. And so there you have it.
STACY. That's it? That's my life? Why are you doing this to me? It's bad enough I'm dead!
GOD. I'm showing you these moments in your life to help you understand…
STACY. Understand what? What can I do now? I'm dead!
GOD. But you don't have to be…
STACY. What?
GOD. Stacy, it must be immediate. Get down on your hands and knees...
STACY. I will, I'll do anything.
GOD. Get down on your hands and knees and promise.
STACY. (*beat*) I promise…
GOD. Well then just wake up…
STACY. What?

(Back in New York, NY in the middle of the street Stacy is 29 and back to life. Literally.)

GOD. (*narrating, to audience*) From that day on…
STACY. Oh....oh, oh my God. Hi! Good morning.
GOD. Stacy Pritchett was changed….
STACY. (*gets out phone*) Hello, mom?
GOD. (*continuing from previous line*) For the better…
STACY. (*on phone to Mom*) I can't....I can't wait to see you tonight. I'm so sorry.
GOD. And Stacy Pritchett learned a very important lesson that day.
STACY. (*on phone to Mom*) I've been wrong about…everything. I know we have not have much more time together but I'm here for you, and only you.
GOD. It's not the moments you spend.
STACY. I love you, mom.
GOD. It's how you spend the moments.

Room to Wait

by Rebecca Spero

CATHY. An attractive southern woman who has been told that her bark is bigger than her bite. She has been suspected of loving her hus band for his money. She is in her 40s.

SAMANTHA. A headstrong high school student who is not pleased about the divorce, re-marriage, and potential death of her father.

(Cathy is reading a magazine and chewing gum when Samantha enters the waiting room.)

SAM. What room is he in?

CATHY. Well, look who finally decided to show up…

SAM. WHAT ROOM IS HE IN?

CATHY. You can't go in, they're running tests.

SAM. I'm his daughter, I'm going in…

CATHY. Samantha Ann, sit.

SAM. What are you, my mother?

CATHY. Stepmother, and the best thing you've got going at the moment…

SAM. Here to collect your half of his estate, Cathy?

CATHY. (*sarcastically*) You can't pass geometry, but you think you know about estate planning?

BOTH. Private school!

CATHY. You know the way you treat your father, one could say the same about you…

SAM. Don't talk to me.

CATHY. Listen, Samantha…

SAM. It's Sam…

CATHY. Right, I forgot, we're still going through the tomboy stage…

SAM. Excuse me?

CATHY. Sam, I know you're upset…but you need to calm down…

SAM. Go fix your exceptionally large, environmentally destructive hairdo.

CATHY. If you don't have something nice to say…

SAM. Say it to your face?

CATHY. Enough.

SAM. Have you heard from the doctors yet?

CATHY. No. They are still waiting on his test results.

SAM. Which will say what?

CATHY. I'm not exactly sure.

SAM. Great…

CATHY. Everything is going to be okay…they say that everything happens for a reason…

SAM. That's easy for you to say. He's not your dad.

CATHY. But he is my husband…

SAM. Third. Your third husband.

CATHY. (*offended and a bit sad*) I love your father, Sam. When are you going to get that through your thick skull?

SAM. Whatever, Cathy. Don't mind me – I'll just be reading my magazine. Waiting for my dad to wake up and for you to leave us alone.

INTRO

(Sam is reading a magazine and Cathy is trying to peek at what she's reading.)

CATHY. Whatcha reading?

SAM. *People.*

CATHY. I love that magazine! I love that section where they talk about who wore what and who wore it best.

SAM. (*bored with Cathy's conversation*) Mmm hmm…

CATHY. Did you see the one where Tyra Banks was wearing that awful swimsuit? She looked like a giant rainbow. And believe me, the only pot of gold at the end of that thing was her giant butt! Do you know what I mean?!? (*Cathy starts to snort from laughing so hard.)*

SAM. Cathy?

CATHY. Sam?

SAM. Shut up.

CATHY. Excuse me?

SAM. SHUT. UP!

CATHY. You know, I thank God every day that you aren't my real daughter, because if I you were I would've already washed that mouth out with ten different bars of soap!

SAM. Try it! I dare you! I'll sue you! I will have the police come and they will lock you and your outrageous hair in a prison!

CATHY. May I ask something?

SAM. What?

CATHY. What's your problem with my hair? You have not stopped talking about it since the first day you laid eyes on me.

SAM. It's just…big…and poofy…and….big.

CATHY. It's no bigger than yours…(*laughs a bit*)…okay you may have a point…

SAM. Thank you! Finally, you see it my way! (*smiles*)

CATHY. (*pause*) I guess my hair is a little big…

SAM. It fits you…

CATHY. Is that a fat joke?

SAM. Good one!

(Both stand, the following lines directed to doctor, who could be a focal point or audience member)

CATHY. (*pause*) Finally!

SAM. How is he?

CATHY. What are you talking about?
SAM. Coma?
CATHY. Well, when can we see him?
SAM. And how long does that take?
CATHY. Really?
SAM. It's okay…we'll just wait…
CATHY. Come get us as soon as he wakes up, okay?
SAM. Just let them do their job, okay, Cathy?
(Doctor is now gone, Cathy and Sam are now talking to each other once more.)
CATHY. I'm sorry – I just – if I lost him – I don't know what I would do. He's the only family I have. I mean, can you imagine?
SAM. Well, considering that my mom left me when I was five and my father is apparently in a coma – I think I could take a pretty good guess.
CATHY. I mean – he's different, you know?
SAM. You mean, different than your other husbands?
CATHY. Samantha…
SAM. Sam!
CATHY. Sam…
SAM. (*cutting Cathy off*) Listen, can you leave me alone? My father is dying and you're talking like you're younger than me!
CATHY. Samantha, I just was grieving…and maybe you need to do the same…
SAM. Don't tell me what to do!
CATHY. What is it with you?
SAM. Excuse me?
CATHY. You've never liked me! Anything I've said, anything I've done, you've never liked me…
SAM. Well, I'm glad you finally know the truth.
CATHY. Finally? FINALLY? Honey, I knew the second we met.
SAM. Whatever.
CATHY. I knew the minute you refused to call me mom.
SAM. Because you're not!
CATHY. What?
SAM. You're not my mom!
CATHY. I'm the only mother you've ever had, Sam!
SAM. Oh, I'm sure.
CATHY. Life is so horrible with me, I know! Well, you know what – you'll get your wish soon enough.
SAM. What!?
CATHY. You'll be rid of me soon enough!
SAM. What's that supposed to mean?
CATHY. (*pause*) Nothing…
SAM. Was that your way of telling me that my dad is going to die?
CATHY. What?
SAM. WAS THAT YOUR WAY OF TELLING ME?

CATHY. NO!
SAM. IS HE GOING TO DIE? YES OR NO?
CATHY. I don't know…(*begins to cry*) I don't know anything anymore…
SAM. (*pause*) I'm sorry…this is not your fault. None of this is your fault. I'm sorry.
CATHY. What?
SAM. I said I'm sorry. I'm sorry for being so hard on you. You know, when my mom left, it was just me and my dad for the longest time. And then one day you came into the picture. I never got over the fact that my mom wasn't coming back and that you weren't going away. But, now I can't imagine life without you.
CATHY. Really?

SAM. I know I don't always act like it, but I'm thankful for you. Really. I mean, you taught me how to fix my hair, how to wear makeup – not that I like to do it…
(Cathy chuckles.)
SAM. Maybe this was dad's way of scaring us together.
CATHY. Yeah, he always did things a little differently…..
(*Doctor enters the room.*)
SAM. Oh, doctor!
CATHY. Is he okay?
SAM. Oh, good!
CATHY. Oh, thank God!
SAM. When can we go in?
CATHY. Well, you don't have to tell me twice! Let me grab my coat!
SAM. Did you say Room 204? We'll be right up!
(Doctor exits. Both grab purses and coats.)
CATHY. Hey…
SAM. Yeah?
CATHY. Thanks for what you said…
SAM. No problem, Cathy….*mom*…No problem, mom.
CATHY. Thank you.
SAM. Let's go see dad.
CATHY. You got it, kiddo. You got it.

The Sisters Smith

by Laura Morris

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) How do I begin to tell this story? Well, let's start by saying…Annie and I have always had a roller coaster of a relationship…

ANNIE. Take it off!

TAYLOR. What?

ANNIE. TAKE. IT. OFF!

TAYLOR. I don't know what you are talking about!

ANNIE. What are you wearing?

TAYLOR. A black skirt…a shirt…

ANNIE. Whose shirt?

TAYLOR. Well, it's yours…but…

ANNIE. Exactly, so take it off!

TAYLOR. But you said I could wear it!

ANNIE. Yeah, well, I have a date tonight and I'm wearing that shirt you have on right now.

TAYLOR. But that's not fair!

ANNIE. Life isn't fair, sister. (*freezes in a demanding pose*)

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) Annie's mother married my father when we were nine, and—at first— we loved living together. Then high school hit.

ANNIE. Mom, can I have the keys?

TAYLOR. (*under her breath*) You better check her math grade…

ANNIE. What did you say, sloth?

TAYLOR. I said you are failing math.

ANNIE. Mom, don't believe….(*her mother is not believing Annie and Annie is now frustrated*) MOTHER! Seriously? You are going to believe her over me? But I'm your real daughter! Taylor, you are such…a freak! Thanks for ruining my life! (*freezes in demanding pose*)

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) She ran with the popular crowd – I was more of a bookworm. (*Annie unfreezes and melts into her current mentally challenged state*) But it was when the accident occurred that we became….closer, I guess you could say.

ANNIE. (*giggly*) Taylor is my best sister.

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) It's hard to explain – but there are situations in life that are almost unexplainable, almost unbelievable that can bring two people together as if they were meant to happen…even though you know good and well that can't possibly be true.

ANNIE. Taylor, I love you. You know that, right?

TAYLOR. I know!

ANNIE. The Sisters Smith!

TAYLOR. (*biting her tongue and trying to not upset Annie*) Yes, that's right Taylor – we are the Sisters Smith.

INTRO

(Taylor is age sixteen and is acting as Annie's caretaker. Because of Annie's mental challenge, she is eighteen in physical years but has the cognitive ability of a four year-old. While Taylor is doing the below lines, Annie is humming to herself softly. The same can be done during all of Taylor's monologues, or can be varied by other ways Annie occupies herself in the interim.)

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) You see, it wasn't always like this…When we were younger, we thought it was so fun that our parents got together. It was like a sleepover every night.

(*In the scene below Taylor is age eight and Annie is age ten, portraying a "flashback". Annie is free from all mental challenges and is acting like a typical ten-year-old girl.)*

ANNIE. Ok, so here's how you play. Each player must try to place the called-out body part on a vacant circle of the called-out color.

TAYLOR. (*singing*) "And that's why they call it Twister!"

ANNIE. Ok, here we go! (*spins*) Taylor, right hand on red!

TAYLOR. (*spins*) Annie, left hand on blue!

ANNIE. (*spins*) Left foot on green!

TAYLOR. (*attempts to move and loses balance*)

ANNIE. I win! I win! I win!

TAYLOR. No fair! Let's play again!

ANNIE. Well, you live here don't you!

TAYLOR. Yeah…

ANNIE. So we can play all night! (*freezes*)

TAYLOR. (*age sixteen*) Growing up, however, presented challenges…I mean…we were girls after all.

(*Taylor is thirteen and Annie is fifteen, portraying a "flashback". Annie is still free from mental challenges in the following flashback. Annie is fixing Taylor's hair.*)

TAYLOR. Ow! You are hurting me!

ANNIE. Listen, if you're ever going to get that curly rats' nest of hair into something the boys can run their hands through – you're going to have to straighten it.

TAYLOR. But it shouldn't hurt!

ANNIE. It will if you have knots in your hair like you do!

TAYLOR. What is that smell?

ANNIE. (*looking shocked*) Oh, Taylor…

TAYLOR. What? What is it?

ANNIE. I may have burned your hair.

TAYLOR. You WHAT!?

ANNIE. You will look fine! It's not a big deal.

TAYLOR. That's because it's not your hair!
ANNIE. Hey – (*grabs scissors*) it's nothing that a pair of scissors can't fix. (*freezes in pose as if she is about to cut Taylor's hair*)

TAYLOR. (*age sixteen, to audience*) I told you we had a roller coaster of a relationship. But it was September twenty-seventh that rocked both of our lives forever. That day…that day stung more than any hair iron ever could.

(The following scene is still considered a flashback scene even though it is longer. Taylor is age sixteen and Annie is age eighteen. The audience catches the girls mid-fight.)

ANNIE. (*with anger*) I can't believe he did that!
TAYLOR. (*defensive*) Well, I've been his daughter since the age of nine.
ANNIE. He took care of you – but you were never his daughter.
TAYLOR. So what? Big deal! Your dad adopted me – that doesn't mean that anything changes other than my last name.
ANNIE. Do you really think you're good enough to be a Smith?
TAYLOR. Excuse me?
ANNIE. Your mother is not my mother. So why is my father suddenly your father?
TAYLOR. Because mine left me. (*pause*)
ANNIE. You don't get it.
TAYLOR. No, you don't get it. You've always had a dad. Do you know what it's like to not know who your father is?
ANNIE. No, but I know what it's like to not have a mom and you don't see me clinging to your mother.
TAYLOR. I didn't think this would upset you.
ANNIE. Yeah, you don't know a lot about me.
TAYLOR. Seriously? I know everything about you.
ANNIE. (*starts to walk out*) I'm out of here.
TAYLOR. Where are you going?
ANNIE. None of your business.
TAYLOR. Do you really think it's a good idea to drive?
ANNIE. You can take away my dad – but you're not going to take away my car. Now step aside! (*Annie leaves.)*

(For mature blocking, Annie can be re-enacting the scene as Taylor gives the below monologue detailing Annie's wreck. This could create a nice portrait of the scene, but is not necessary for the audience to understand.)

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) It's hard to not blame myself for what happened next. After all, I am the one that made her upset. But when Annie got into her car – she was talking on her cell phone. She hit a semitruck head on.

(Annie is now mentally challenged for the rest of the duo. She enters and begins listening to Taylor.)

TAYLOR. We're lucky to even have her. The doctors said it was a miracle she didn't die.
ANNIE. Who died?
TAYLOR. No one died, Annie.
ANNIE. Who are you talking to?
TAYLOR. None of your business…
ANNIE. You're silly, sister!
TAYLOR. I know…
ANNIE. I'm going to get a game for us to play, sister.
TAYLOR. Okay…I'll be in your room in a minute and we'll play.
ANNIE. Okie dokie Miss Pinnochie!

TAYLOR. (*to audience*) You know, sometimes I think about what would have happened that day if her father had not adopted me. I have replayed the day in mind a million times thinking what if that conversation never would have happened. (*Tears begin to well in her eyes.*) And then I feel guilty – that the only reason I take care of Annie is to recount the guilt that I feel every single day. I feel guilty for the fact that I wanted a father so bad that it came at another's expense. That if I had just been content with just me and mom – none of this would have ever happened. It makes me like a bad person. It makes me feel selfish. (*begins to cry*)

(Annie enters.)

ANNIE. Sister, why are you crying?
TAYLOR. I'm not crying, Annie.
ANNIE. Oh, yes, you are, I can see them in your eyeballs.
TAYLOR. (*laughs*) That's because you're very observant.
ANNIE. I don't know what that means – but I like it.
TAYLOR. It means you notice parts of me that many don't.
ANNIE. Oh. I still like it!
TAYLOR. Well, I thought we were going to play a game?
ANNIE. Well, I waited and you never came into my room – so I brought the game to you!
TAYLOR. Good idea. Let's get playing!
ANNIE. (*begins to open up the board game*)
TAYLOR. (*to audience*) And then there are moments like these – that I would not trade for the world. And I suddenly realize that I was place in this family for a reason. (looks at Annie) A very special reason.
ANNIE. (*spins*) Okay – right hand on red!
TAYLOR. (*spins*) Okay – left hand on blue!
ANNIE. (*spins*) Okay – left foot on green!

TAYLOR. (*spins*) Okay – okay….(*loses balance*) Awww!
ANNIE. I win! I win!
TAYLOR. Yes, you win! This time…you win…

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